

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION CLINICAL POLICY

Official Medical Necessity Guidelines Catalog & Payer Criteria Rules

This document details the official prior authorization clinical necessity guidelines defined by Payer Enrollment Services. These guidelines are compiled and verified by medical directors to govern claims approvals for diagnostic and pharmaceutical requests. All review workflows must align with the active policy definitions outlined below.

Active Policy Code Matrix

Policy ID	CPT Code	Service Name	Eligible Diagnoses (ICD-10)
POL-RAD-402	73721	MRI Knee Joint	M25.561, M25.562, M25.569, S83.206A
POL-PHARM-809	J0135	Adalimumab (Humira)	M05.79, M06.9
POL-EVI-402	73721	eviCore MRI Knee	M25.561, M25.562, M25.569, S83.206A

Section 1: MRI Knee Joint Clinical Necessity (POL-RAD-402)

Requests for magnetic resonance imaging of the knee joint must satisfy all criteria below:

- Symptom Duration:** Documented persistent knee pain of at least 6 weeks.
- Conservative Care:** Documented failure of conservative management (physical therapy, NSAID regimen, or rest) of at least 6 weeks.
- Objective Findings:** Physical examination records must report joint tenderness, swelling, locking, or joint instability.

Section 2: Biologic Rheumatoid Arthritis Therapy (POL-PHARM-809)

Requests for specialty biologic agents (e.g. Humira, CPT J0135) must satisfy the following clinical rules:

- Diagnosis:** Confirmed active Rheumatoid Arthritis (ICD-10 codes M05.79, M06.9).
- DMARD Failure:** Documented lack of clinical response to conventional Disease-Modifying Antirheumatic Drugs (e.g., methotrexate) for at least 3 months (12 weeks).
- Consultation:** Treatment must be prescribed by or in consultation with a rheumatologist.

Section 3: UnitedHealthcare / eviCore Advanced Knee Imaging (POL-EVI-402)

Requests governed by UnitedHealthcare / eviCore musculoskeletal guidelines require prior clinical screening:

- Prior Radiographs:** Plain radiographs (X-rays) of the knee joint must be performed and documented after the onset of the current knee symptoms, prior to scheduling advanced imaging (MRI).
- Symptom Duration:** Persistent pain of at least 6 weeks.
- Conservative Care:** Documented failure of conservative management (physical therapy or NSAIDs) for at least 6 weeks.

4. **Objective Findings:** Documented physical exam findings (tenderness, locking, joint swelling, or instability).

Notice: Administrative guidelines mandate that requests not meeting the automated OPA criteria must be escalated to a Human Medical Director for review. Rejections may not be processed by automated agents.